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Fiber optic connector having flattened regions that face and align to prevent rotation

Abstract

An optical fiber connector sub-assembly for an optical fiber connector includes a ferrule configured to hold an optical fiber therein, a ferrule holder configured to hold the ferrule, a retaining tube configured to hold the ferrule holder and receive a fiber optic cable, and a connecting tube configured to be rotatably coupled with the ferrule holder and slidably received by the retaining tube. The ferrule holder, the retaining tube, and the connecting tube are configured to receive an optical fiber, and the retaining tube and the connecting tube are configured to cooperate with one another to prevent relative rotation between the ferrule holder and the retaining tube.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. Nonprovisional application Ser. No. 16/900,861 filed Jun. 12, 2020, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/860,283, filed Jun. 12, 2019, the disclosures of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties.

BACKGROUND

(1) The present disclosure relates to an optical fiber connector, for example, an LC (Lucent

Connector) connector. More particularly, the disclosure relates to a fiber optic connector that prevents a fiber that is connected to the connector from rotating relative to the connector when being pushed through a duct or conduit.

(2) The mechanical tolerances involved in terminating single mode optical fiber are much tighter than those for multimode optical fiber. Therefore, while it is quite common for multimode optical fiber be terminated at the point of use, for example, at a user's premises or at an outside junction box, in most product applications, single mode optical fiber is not terminated in the field. When single mode fiber must be terminated in the field, then it can take a skilled technician between about 15 to 20 minutes to splice fibers together either by using a V-groove clamp or expensive fusion welding equipment.

(3) Single mode fiber is therefore often provided in a range of different lengths, pre-terminated at both ends with a connector that is configured to be connected with an outer housing after the pre-terminated end is deployed to its desired location. The pre-terminated end and housing is then ready to plug into a matching receptacle.

(4) One example of such a connector is an LC connector. The LC connector and adapters were originally developed by Lucent Technologies. The LC connector is a miniaturized version of the fiber optic SC (Subscriber Connector) connector, thus being also known as a small form factor connector. The LC connector looks somewhat similar to the SC connector, but is about half the size with a 1.25 mm ferrule instead of a 2.5 mm ferrule. LC connectors are typically composed of a plastic housing with an RJ45 push-pull style clip.

(5) Conventional optical fiber LC connectors comprise a rigid pushable structure to allow for limited movement of the connector parts while being pushed down stretches of duct. However, conventional optical fiber LC connectors permit rotation between the fiber and the connector when the connector is being pushed through the duct. Such rotation could cause damage to the fiber, which may result in signal degradation or signal loss.

(6) Therefore, it may be desirable to provide an optical fiber connector that prevents rotation of the fiber relative to the connector while being pushed through a duct or conduct.

SUMMARY

(7) In accordance with various embodiments of the disclosure, an optical fiber connector sub-assembly for an optical fiber connector includes a ferrule configured to hold an optical fiber therein along an axis of the connector, a ferrule holder configured to hold the ferrule at a front portion of the connector, a retaining tube having a front end portion configured to hold the ferrule holder and a rear end portion configured to receive a fiber optic cable, and a connecting tube configured to be received in the ferrule holder in a press fit relationship such that the connecting tube is rotatably coupled with the ferrule holder, and the connecting tube being configured to be slidably received by the retaining tube. The ferrule holder, the retaining tube, and the connecting tube are configured to receive an optical fiber, and the ferrule is configured to terminate the optical fiber. The connecting tube includes a head portion having a flattened region, and wherein the retaining tube includes an inner wall having a flattened inner region configured to be aligned with the flattened region of the connecting tube to prevent relative rotation between the ferrule holder and the retaining tube.

(8) According to various aspects, a fiber optic connector includes the aforementioned optical fiber connector sub-assembly and an outer housing configured to be coupled with the optical fiber connector sub-assembly. The outer housing is configured to provide LC-style push/pull engagement/disengagement with a mating optical fiber socket.

(9) In some aspects, the retaining tube includes a forward end portion and a rearward end portion, the forward end portion and the rearward end portion being separated at an interior of the retaining tube by an inner annular shoulder.

(10) In various aspects, the forward end portion of the retaining tube includes a bore configured to slidably receive at least a portion of the cylindrical stem portion of the ferrule holder, the rearward

end portion of the retaining tube includes a bore configured to slidably receive the connecting tube, and the connecting tube extends through a bore defined by the inner annular shoulder.

(11) According to some aspects, the head portion of the elongated cylindrical portion of the connecting tube includes at least one additional flattened region, and the inner wall of the rearward end portion of the retaining tube includes at least one additional flattened inner region configured to be aligned with the at least one additional flattened region of the connecting tube.

(12) According to various embodiments of the disclosure, an optical fiber connector sub-assembly for an optical fiber connector includes a ferrule configured to hold an optical fiber therein, a ferrule holder configured to hold the ferrule, a retaining tube having a front end portion configured to hold the ferrule holder and a rear end portion configured to receive a fiber optic cable, and a connecting tube configured to be rotatably coupled with the ferrule holder and slidably received by the retaining tube. The ferrule holder, the retaining tube, and the connecting tube are configured to receive an optical fiber, and the connecting tube includes a head portion having a flattened region. The retaining tube includes an inner wall having a flattened inner region configured to be aligned with the flattened region of the connecting tube to prevent relative rotation between the ferrule holder and the retaining tube.

(13) According to various aspects, a fiber optic connector includes the aforementioned optical fiber connector sub-assembly and an outer housing configured to be coupled with the optical fiber connector sub-assembly. The outer housing is configured to provide LC-style push/pull engagement/disengagement with a mating optical fiber socket.

(14) In some aspects, the retaining tube includes a forward end portion and a rearward end portion, the forward end portion and the rearward end portion being separated at an interior of the retaining tube by an inner annular shoulder.

(15) In various aspects, the forward end portion of the retaining tube includes a bore configured to slidably receive at least a portion of the cylindrical stem portion of the ferrule holder, the rearward end portion of the retaining tube includes a bore configured to slidably receive the connecting tube, and the connecting tube extends through a bore defined by the inner annular shoulder.

(16) According to some aspects, the head portion of the elongated cylindrical portion of the connecting tube includes at least one additional flattened region, and the inner wall of the rearward end portion of the retaining tube includes at least one additional flattened inner region configured to be aligned with the at least one additional flattened region of the connecting tube.

(17) In accordance with various embodiments of the disclosure, an optical fiber connector sub-assembly for an optical fiber connector includes a ferrule configured to hold an optical fiber therein, a ferrule holder configured to hold the ferrule, a retaining tube configured to hold the ferrule holder and receive a fiber optic cable, and a connecting tube configured to be rotatably coupled with the ferrule holder and slidably received by the retaining tube. The ferrule holder, the retaining tube, and the connecting tube are configured to receive an optical fiber, and the retaining tube and the connecting tube are configured to cooperate with one another to prevent relative rotation between the ferrule holder and the retaining tube.

(18) According to various aspects, a fiber optic connector includes the aforementioned optical fiber connector sub-assembly and an outer housing configured to be coupled with the optical fiber connector sub-assembly. The outer housing is configured to provide LC-style push/pull engagement/disengagement with a mating optical fiber socket.

(19) In some aspects, the retaining tube includes a forward end portion and a rearward end portion, the forward end portion and the rearward end portion being separated at an interior of the retaining tube by an inner annular shoulder.

(20) In various aspects, the forward end portion of the retaining tube includes a bore configured to slidably receive at least a portion of the cylindrical stem portion of the ferrule holder, the rearward end portion of the retaining tube includes a bore configured to slidably receive the connecting tube, and the connecting tube extends through a bore defined by the inner annular shoulder.

- (21) According to some aspects, the connecting tube includes an elongated cylindrical portion having a head portion at its rear end, the head portion including a flattened region, and the rearward end portion of the retaining tube includes an inner wall having a flattened inner region configured to be aligned with the flattened region of the connecting tube.
- (22) According to various aspects, the head portion of the elongated cylindrical portion of the connecting tube includes at least one additional flattened region, and the inner wall of the rearward end portion of the retaining tube includes at least one additional flattened inner region configured to be aligned with the at least one additional flattened region of the connecting tube.
- (23) In some aspects, a forward end portion of the connecting tube is configured to be received in the ferrule holder in a press fit relationship such that the connecting tube is rotatable with the ferrule holder.
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Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) Embodiments of the invention will now be further described, by way of example only, and with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 is an exploded perspective view of an exemplary fiber optic connector in accordance with various aspects of the disclosure;
- (3) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of the connector subassembly of the fiber optic connector of FIG. 1;
- (4) FIG. 3 is a cross-sectional perspective view of the connector subassembly of FIG. 2;
- (5) FIG. 4 is a cross-sectional view of a portion of the connector subassembly of FIG. 2;
- (6) FIG. 5 is a perspective view of the fiber optic connector of FIG. 1;
- (7) FIG. 6 is a perspective view of a portion of the fiber optic connector of FIG. 1;
- (8) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of another exemplary fiber optic connector in accordance with various aspects of the disclosure;
- (9) FIG. 8 is a cross-sectional perspective view of the connector subassembly of FIG. 7;
- (10) FIG. 9 is a cross-sectional perspective view of the connector subassembly of FIG. 7;
- (11) FIG. 10 is an exploded, cross-sectional perspective view of the connector subassembly of FIG. 7;
- (12) FIG. 11 is an exploded, cross-sectional perspective view of a portion of the connector subassembly of FIG. 7;
- (13) FIG. 12 is a perspective view of another connector sub-assembly for the fiber optic connector of FIG. 7;
- (14) FIG. 13 is a cross-sectional perspective view of the connector subassembly of FIG. 12; and
- (15) FIG. 14 is a cross-sectional perspective view of a portion of the connector subassembly of FIG. 12.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

- (16) FIGS. 1-6 illustrate an exemplary fiber optic connector **100**, for example, an LC connector, in accordance with various aspects of the disclosure. The fiber optic connector **100** includes a connector sub-assembly **102** and an outer housing **104**. In some aspects, the outer housing **104** may be an LC housing configured to be received by a conventional matching LC receptacle. That is, the outer housing **104** may be configured to provide LC-style push/pull engagement/disengagement with a mating optical fiber socket (not shown). The fiber optic connector **100** is configured to be coupled with a fiber optic cable **106**. For example, an end of the cable **106** is configured to be terminated with the connector sub-assembly **102**.
- (17) The connector sub-assembly **102** includes an elongate cylindrical optical fiber ferrule **112** having at one end a termination end **114**. In this example, the ferrule **112** is of a ceramic material,

although other materials may be used, as is known in the art. The ferrule **112** has an axis **116** that extends centrally through the fiber optic connector **100**, and along its axis **116** has a hollow core **118** that holds and aligns an optical fiber **108** of the cable **106**, which will most often be a single mode glass fiber. The person skilled in the art will recognize this as a conventional arrangement, in which the fiber **108** is terminated at the ferrule termination end **114**, which is polished to minimize insertion loss when the connector is joined to a matching optical fiber socket (not shown).

(18) The connector sub-assembly **102** also includes a ferrule holder **120** (i.e. a holding portion), a generally cylindrical retaining tube **130** (i.e., a retaining tube), and a connecting tube **140** (i.e. connecting portion). The ferrule holder **120** has a base portion **122** at its forward end in which the ferrule **112** is seated, a collar **123**, and a cylindrical stem portion **124** which extends from the collar **123** in an axial direction away from the ferrule **112**. The collar **123** includes an external annular shoulder **126** and an internal annular shoulder **128**. The base portion **122** is configured to receive the ferrule **112** in a press-fit relationship with a rear face of the ferrule **122** abutting a forward face **127a** of the internal annular shoulder **128**, as would be understood by persons skilled in the art.

(19) The retaining tube **130** includes a forward end portion **132** and a rearward end portion **134**. The forward end portion **132** and the rearward end portion **134** are separated at an interior of the retaining tube **130** by an inner annular shoulder **136**. The forward end portion **132** includes an external shoulder portion **133** defining a rearward facing surface. The forward end portion **132** includes a bore **131** configured to slidably receive at least a portion of the cylindrical stem portion **124** of the ferrule holder **120**. The rearward end portion **134** includes a bore **135** configured to slidably receive the connecting tube **140**, which extends through a closely fitting bore **137** defined by the inner annular shoulder **136**.

(20) The connecting tube **140** includes an elongated cylindrical portion **141** having a head portion **142** at its rear end. The head portion **142** has a larger cross-section in a plane perpendicular to the ferrule axis than does the elongated cylindrical portion **141**. The head portion **142** may be generally cylindrical, but includes a flattened region **143** that forms, for example, a chord, such that the head portion **142** is formed in a D-shape as viewed in the axial direction.

(21) A forward end portion of the elongated cylindrical portion **141** is configured to be received in the cylindrical stem portion **124**, for example, in a press fit relationship, more particularly, a light press fit connection. The press fit relationship should be sufficient such that the connecting tube **140** is rotatable with the cylindrical stem portion **124** about ferrule axis **116** and not rotatable relative to the cylindrical stem portion **124** when the connector subassembly **102** is being pushed through a duct or conduct. The forward end face **144** at the forward end portion of the elongated cylindrical portion **141** abuts a rearward face **127b** of the internal annular shoulder **128** of the collar **123**. A forward face **146** of the head portion **142** abuts a rearward face **136a** of the inner annular shoulder **136** of the retaining tube **130**.

(22) The rearward end portion **134** of the retaining tube **130** includes a small inner diameter portion **150** adjacent the inner annular shoulder **136** and a large inner diameter portion **152** extending axially from the small inner diameter portion **150** in a direction away from the inner annular shoulder **136**. The large inner diameter portion **152** has a larger inside diameter than the small inner diameter portion **150**. The retaining tube **130** may include a tapered or stepped transition between the small inner diameter portion **150** and the large inner diameter portion **152**.

(23) The large inner diameter portion **152** is sized and configured to receive the cable **106**, including a sheath **107** that protects the fiber **108**. After receiving the cable **106**, including the sheath **107**, the large diameter portion **152** is crimped onto the sheath **107** of the cable **106**, as shown in FIGS. 1 and 2. The small inner diameter portion **150** has a smaller diameter than the outside diameter of the sheath **107** and is thus sized and configured to prevent the sheath **107** from entering the small diameter portion **150**. However, the small inner diameter portion **150** is sized and configured to receive the fiber **108** and buffering layers **109** that encircle the fiber **108** and are encircled by the sheath **107**. Thus, the transition between the small inner diameter portion **150** and

the large inner diameter portion **152** provides a stop for limiting the axial insertion of the cable **106** into the retaining tube **130**.

(24) The small diameter portion **150** of the retaining tube **130** includes a deformed region **151** that protrudes radially inward from an inner wall **135a** of the bore **135** of the small diameter portion **150**. The deformed region **151** may be formed by controlled peening, crimping, or the like. The deformed region **151** forms an indent having a flattened inner region **151a** configured to be aligned with the flattened region **143** of the head portion **142** of the connecting tube **140**. When the head portion **142** of the connecting tube **140** is received in the generally cylindrical bore small diameter portion **150** of the retaining tube **130**, the deformed region **151** cooperates with the flattened region **143** of the head portion **142** to prevent relative rotation between the connecting tube **140** and the retaining tube **130**.

(25) The connector sub-assembly **102** further includes a coil spring **160** disposed between the connecting tube **140** and the retaining tube **130** in a radial direction and retained in an axial direction between a rear end face **125** of the cylindrical stem portion **124** and a forward face **138** of the inner annular shoulder **136**. The coil spring **160** biases the ferrule holder **120** forwardly relative to the retaining tube **130**, with the forward bias being limited by the abutment between the forward face **146** of the head portion **142** and the rearward face **136a** of the inner annular shoulder **136** of the retaining tube **130**. The coil spring **160** is compressible in the axial direction by axial sliding movement of the stem portion **124** relative to the retaining tube **130**. The axial range of travel of the ferrule holder **120** and connecting tube **140** is determined by the axial length of the small inner diameter portion **150** of the retaining tube **130**, as shown in FIG. 4.

(26) The connector **100** may further include a removable protective cap **162** having a bore configured to receive the ferrule **112**. The connector **100** may also include a tubular member **164** having a through bore configured to receive the fiber **108** and the buffering layers **109** and to be inserted between the buffering layers **109** and the sheath **107** at the end of the sheath **107**. The tubular member **164** may protect the fiber **108** during crimping of the large diameter portion **152** of the retaining tube **130**. The tubular member **164** includes an outer shoulder **166** at its forward end to limit insertion of the tubular member **164** into the sheath **107** of the cable **106**. The small inner diameter portion **150** is sized and configured to receive the outer shoulder **166**. The connector **100** may also include a boot **168** around the cable **106** that is configured to abut the rearward end of the connecting tube **130** and the rearward end of the outer housing **104**. The boot **168** is configured to provide strain relief for the cable **106** and a weather resistant seal at the rearward end of the connector **100**.

(27) The outer housing **104** is configured in a substantially square shape with a release lever **108** projecting outward from a top wall **174** of the outer housing **104**, for example, as is typical with conventional LC connectors. The outer housing **104** includes a through bore **170** configured to receive the connector sub-assembly **102** such that the ferrule **112** can be exposed at a front end **172** of the outer housing **104**. The inner surfaces of the top wall **174** and a bottom wall **176** of the outer housing **104** include alignment ribs **178**. The alignment ribs **178** are configured to be received by axial alignment channels **129**, **139** in the outer walls of the ferrule holder **120** and the retaining tube **130**, respectively. The alignment channels **129**, **139** are disposed at diametrically opposed top and bottom portions of the ferrule holder **120** and the retaining tube **130**, respectively. In some aspects, the outer wall of the ferrule holder **120** may include only a single alignment rib, and the outer housing may include only a single alignment channel.

(28) The alignment ribs **178** are tapered from a first width (i.e., in a direction perpendicular to the ferrule axis) at a forward end **180** to a second width at a rearward end **182**. The first width of the ribs **178** substantially matches a width of the alignment channels **129**, **139**. The tapered profile allows freedom of movement and the rearward end **182** of the ribs **178** serves as a hard stop relative to a rearward end of the alignment channels **139** of the retaining tube **130**.

(29) The outer housing **104** further includes side walls **184** having resilient fingers **185** extending

inward into the through bore **170**. Each of the resilient fingers **185** may be cantilevered at its rear end **186**, and the free forward end **188** of each finger **185** is configured to engage the rearward facing surface of the external shoulder portion **133** of the forward end portion **132** of the retaining tube **130** when the retaining tube **130** is inserted into the outer housing **104** to couple the housing **104** with the sub-assembly **102**.

(30) Referring now to FIGS. **7-11**, another exemplary fiber optic connector **700**, for example, an LC connector, in accordance with various aspects of the disclosure is illustrated. The exemplary fiber optic connector **700** is similar to the fiber optic connector described above, except that the small diameter portion **750** of the retaining tube **730** includes a cross-sectional profile **751** along its length that matches the D-shaped profile of the head portion **742** of the connecting tube **740**. When the head portion **142** of the connecting tube **740** is received in the generally cylindrical bore small diameter portion **750** of the retaining tube **730**, the cross-sectional profile **751** cooperates with the D-shaped profile of the head portion **742** to prevent relative rotation between the connecting tube **740** and the retaining tube **730**.

(31) As shown in FIGS. **8-10**, the outer walls of the ferrule holder **720** and the retaining tube **730** may be generally cylindrical with flattened regions **729**, **739** that are aligned with one another. The outer housing **704** may include a bore having a top wall **774** with a flattened inner surface **778** configured to be aligned with the flattened regions **729**, **739** of the ferrule holder **720** and the retaining tube **730**, respectively, to prevent relative rotation between the outer housing **704** and the connector sub-assembly **702**.

(32) Referring now to FIGS. **12-14**, another exemplary fiber optic connector subassembly **1204** in accordance with various aspects of the disclosure is illustrated. The exemplary fiber optic connector sub-assembly is for use with the fiber optic connector **700**, and is similar to the fiber optic connector sub-assemblies **102**, **702** described above, except that head portion **1242** of the connecting tube **1240** has a hex profile, and the small diameter portion **1250** of the retaining tube **1230** includes a matching hex profile **1251** along its length. When the head portion **1242** of the connecting tube **1240** is received in the generally cylindrical bore small diameter portion **1250** of the retaining tube **1230**, the cross-sectional hex profile **1251** cooperates with the hex profile of the head portion **1242** to prevent relative rotation between the connecting tube **1240** and the retaining tube **1230**.

(33) It should be appreciated that although the outer housing **104** is illustrated as transparent to facilitate an understanding of the connector, the outer housing is not typically transparent.

(34) It should be noted that although the specific example described above relates to LC-type connectors, the optical fiber connector sub-assembly can be adapted for use with other types of optical fiber connector systems, for example SC-type connectors and ST-type connectors.

(35) Additional embodiments include any one of the embodiments described above, where one or more of its components, functionalities or structures is interchanged with, replaced by or augmented by one or more of the components, functionalities, or structures of a different embodiment described above.

(36) It should be understood that various changes and modifications to the embodiments described herein will be apparent to those skilled in the art. Such changes and modifications can be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure and without diminishing its intended advantages. It is therefore intended that such changes and modifications be covered by the appended claims.

(37) Although several embodiments of the disclosure have been disclosed in the foregoing specification, it is understood by those skilled in the art that many modifications and other embodiments of the disclosure will come to mind to which the disclosure pertains, having the benefit of the teaching presented in the foregoing description and associated drawings. It is thus understood that the disclosure is not limited to the specific embodiments disclosed herein above, and that many modifications and other embodiments are intended to be included within the scope

of the appended claims. Moreover, although specific terms are employed herein, as well as in the claims which follow, they are used only in a generic and descriptive sense, and not for the purposes of limiting the present disclosure, nor the claims which follow.

Claims

1. An optical fiber connector sub-assembly for an optical fiber connector, comprising: a ferrule configured to hold an optical fiber therein along an axis of the connector; a holding portion configured to hold the ferrule at a front portion of the connector; a retaining tube having a front end portion configured to hold the holding portion and a rear end portion configured to receive a fiber optic cable; a connecting tube configured to be received in the holding portion in a press fit relationship such that the connecting portion tube is rotatably coupled with the holding portion; wherein the connecting tube is configured to be slidably received by the retaining tube; wherein the holding portion, the retaining tube, portion tube, and the connecting tube are configured to receive an optical fiber; wherein the connecting tube includes a head portion having a radially outward facing surface with a flattened region; and wherein the retaining tube includes an inner wall having a radially inward facing wall with a flattened region configured to face and be aligned with the flattened region of the connecting tube to prevent relative rotation between the holding portion and the retaining tube.
2. A connector comprising: the optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 1; and an outer housing configured to be coupled with the optical fiber connector subassembly.
3. The connector of claim 2, wherein the outer housing is configured to provide Lucent Connection (LC) push/pull engagement/disengagement with a mating optical fiber socket.
4. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 1, wherein the retaining tube includes a forward end portion and a rearward end portion, the forward end portion and the rearward end portion being separated at an interior of the retaining tube by an inner annular shoulder.
5. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 4, wherein the forward end portion of the retaining tube includes a bore configured to slidably receive at least a portion of the holding portion, wherein the rearward end portion of the retaining tube includes a bore configured to slidably receive the connecting tube, and wherein the connecting tube extends through a bore defined by the inner annular shoulder.
6. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 1, wherein the head portion of the connecting tube includes at least one additional flattened region, and wherein the inner wall of the rearward end portion of the retaining tube includes at least one additional flattened region configured to be aligned with the at least one additional flattened region of the connecting tube.
7. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 1, further comprising a biasing portion disposed between a rearmost surface of the holding portion and a forward facing surface of the retaining tube.
8. An optical fiber connector sub-assembly for an optical fiber connector, comprising: a ferrule configured to hold an optical fiber therein; a holding portion configured to hold a ferrule; a retaining tube having a front end portion configured to hold the holding portion and a rear end portion configured to receive a fiber optic cable; and a connecting portion configured to be received in and rotatably coupled with the holding portion and slidably received by the retaining tube, wherein the holding portion, the retaining tube, and the connecting portion are configured to receive an optical fiber, and wherein the connecting portion includes a head portion having a radially outward facing surface with a flattened region, and wherein the retaining tube includes an inner wall having a radially inward facing wall with a flattened region configured to face and be aligned with the flattened region of the connecting portion to prevent relative rotation between the holding portion and the retaining tube.
9. A connector comprising: the optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 8; and an outer

housing configured to be coupled with the optical fiber connector subassembly.

10. The connector of claim 9, wherein the outer housing is configured to provide Lucent Connection (LC) push/pull engagement/disengagement with a mating optical fiber socket.

11. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 8, wherein the retaining tube includes a forward end portion and a rearward end portion, and wherein the forward end portion and the rearward end portion are configured to be separated at an interior of the retaining tube by an inner annular shoulder.

12. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 11, wherein the forward end portion of the retaining tube includes a bore configured to slidably receive at least a portion of the holding portion; wherein the rearward end portion of the retaining tube includes a bore configured to slidably receive the connecting portion; and wherein the connecting portion extends through a bore defined by the inner annular shoulder.

13. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 8, wherein the head portion of the connecting portion includes at least one additional flattened region; and wherein the inner wall of the rearward end portion of the retaining tube includes at least one additional flattened region configured to be aligned with the at least one additional flattened region of the connecting portion.

14. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 8, further comprising a biasing portion disposed between a rearmost surface of the holding portion and a forward facing surface of the retaining tube.

15. An optical fiber connector sub-assembly for an optical fiber connector, comprising: a holding portion configured to hold a ferrule; a retaining tube configured to hold the holding portion and to receive a fiber optic cable; a connecting portion configured to be received in and rotatably coupled with the holding portion and slidably received by the retaining tube; wherein the holding portion, the retaining tube, and the connecting portion are configured to receive an optical fiber; and wherein the retaining tube includes a radially inward facing flattened region configured to face and be aligned with a radially outward facing flattened region of the connecting portion to prevent relative rotation between the holding portion and the retaining tube.

16. A connector comprising: the optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 15; and an outer housing configured to be coupled with the optical fiber connector subassembly.

17. The connector of claim 16, wherein the outer housing is configured to provide Lucent Connection (LC) push/pull engagement/disengagement with a mating optical fiber socket.

18. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 15, wherein the retaining tube includes a forward end portion and a rearward end portion, and wherein the forward end portion and the rearward end portion are configured to be separated at an interior of the retaining tube by an inner annular shoulder.

19. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 18, wherein the forward end portion of the retaining tube includes a bore configured to slidably receive at least a portion of the holding portion; wherein the rearward end portion of the retaining tube includes a bore configured to slidably receive the connecting portion; and wherein the connecting portion extends through a bore defined by the inner annular shoulder.

20. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 18, wherein the connecting portion includes an elongated cylindrical portion having a head portion at its rear end, the head portion including a flattened region; and wherein the rearward end portion of the retaining tube includes an inner wall having a flattened region configured to be aligned with the flattened region of the connecting portion.

21. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 20, wherein the head portion of the connecting portion includes at least one additional flattened region; and wherein the inner wall of the rearward end portion of the retaining tube includes at least one additional flattened region configured to be aligned with the at least one additional flattened region of the connecting portion.

22. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 18, wherein a forward end portion of the

connecting portion is configured to be received in the holding portion in a press fit relationship such that the connecting portion is rotatable with the holding portion.

23. The optical fiber connector sub-assembly of claim 15, further comprising a biasing portion disposed between a rearmost surface of the holding portion and a forward facing surface of the retaining tube.
